



Meet the Challengers

With social networking skills becoming almost a requisite for success these days, can you really afford to put all your eggs in one basket?

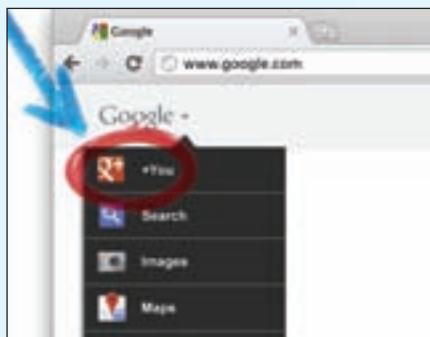
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Friendster, Myspace, Orkut, Livejournal... Facebook's had a number of victories since its inception in early 2004. Zuckerberg and crew work around the clock to provide the social network for 800+ million (and growing) users. Social gaming, subscriptions and new features such as the Timeline ensure that the online world continues to spend hundreds of millions of man hours on the site every day!

However, as we all know, the world has moved towards evaluating your "worth" (as a friend, colleague, employee and generally all-round human being with a life), based on how active, popular and witty you come across online. In such a scenario, it defeats the purpose to depend on just one service to network with, and thus the point of this article.

Google+ Have you +1-ed yet?

Google+ launched last summer bringing features such as Circles (to organise friends into neat little groups) and Hangouts (to create group chats and record impromptu video webcasts). Google+ interconnects very well with all the other Google services – search, Gmail and YouTube to exploit the new +1 option for various impacts on SEO and surfing.



Google+ is perhaps the second most talked about networking site today

Many users reportedly switched to Google+ from Facebook, mainly because of Google's assurance that personal information would never be shared with third parties – something Facebook can't offer. Google+ already has 90+ million users, and at the rate of growth we've seen, 400 million users by the end of this year looks oddly feasible.

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Tumblr's micro-blogging is a favourite among teens and college students.